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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

SHARJAH BOOK FAIR WOWS STUDENTS AND VISITORS

Students and visitors throng the stalls of Sharjah International Book Fair at Expo Centre Sharjah. The 44th edition, which runs until November 16, has a packed schedule of more than 1,200 events and over 250 authors and creatives from 66 countries. **SEE ALSO P4**

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Business bank account opening time cut by 90%

DUBAI UNIFIED LICENCE SYSTEM HELPS TO SET IT UP IN 5 DAYS

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

The Dubai Business Registration and Licensing Corporation (DBLC), part of the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism, has achieved a major milestone in improving business efficiency, cutting the average time to open a business bank account from 65 days to just five.

The result follows the roll-out of the Dubai Unified Licence (DUL) system, a centralised business identity framework introduced to simplify company set-up and operations. Since its launch in 2023, the DUL has accelerated service delivery across banking, utilities, and trade facilitation, supporting the goals of the Dubai Economic Agenda, D33, to double the size of the emirate's economy by 2033.

Service Providers Project

The DUL was enhanced last year with the Service Providers Project, which enables businesses to access essential government and private sector

65 days

was the average time
to open a business
bank account earlier

3,000

accounts opened
through new system
since October 2024

services through a single digital platform. Since October 2024, more than 3,000 new business bank accounts have been opened through the system, and over 134,000 business profiles updated.

In total, more than 900,000 unified licences have been issued to companies operating across Dubai's mainland and free zones. The initiative is designed to make it easier for entrepreneurs, SMEs, and international investors to establish and expand operations in the city.

"The success of the DUL initiative also showcases how collaboration between government entities and the private sector can deliver real benefits for businesses and service providers through our shared determination to build a transparent, investor-friendly environment that supports the goals of the D33 Agenda," said Ahmad Khalifa AlQaizi AlFalasi, CEO of DBLC.

Leading banks join in

Several leading banks are already part of the DUL ecosystem, including Emirates Islamic Bank, Mashreq Bank, Commercial Bank of Dubai, First Abu Dhabi Bank, Emirates NBD, Emirates Development Bank, and ruya Bank.

The system's integration extends beyond banking. Partnerships with key government and service entities, including the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratization (MoHRE), Dubai Electricity and Water Authority (Dewa), Dubai Trade, Roads and Transport Authority (RTA), Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA), and Arab Financial Services (AFS), are enhancing cross-sector connectivity and transparency.



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